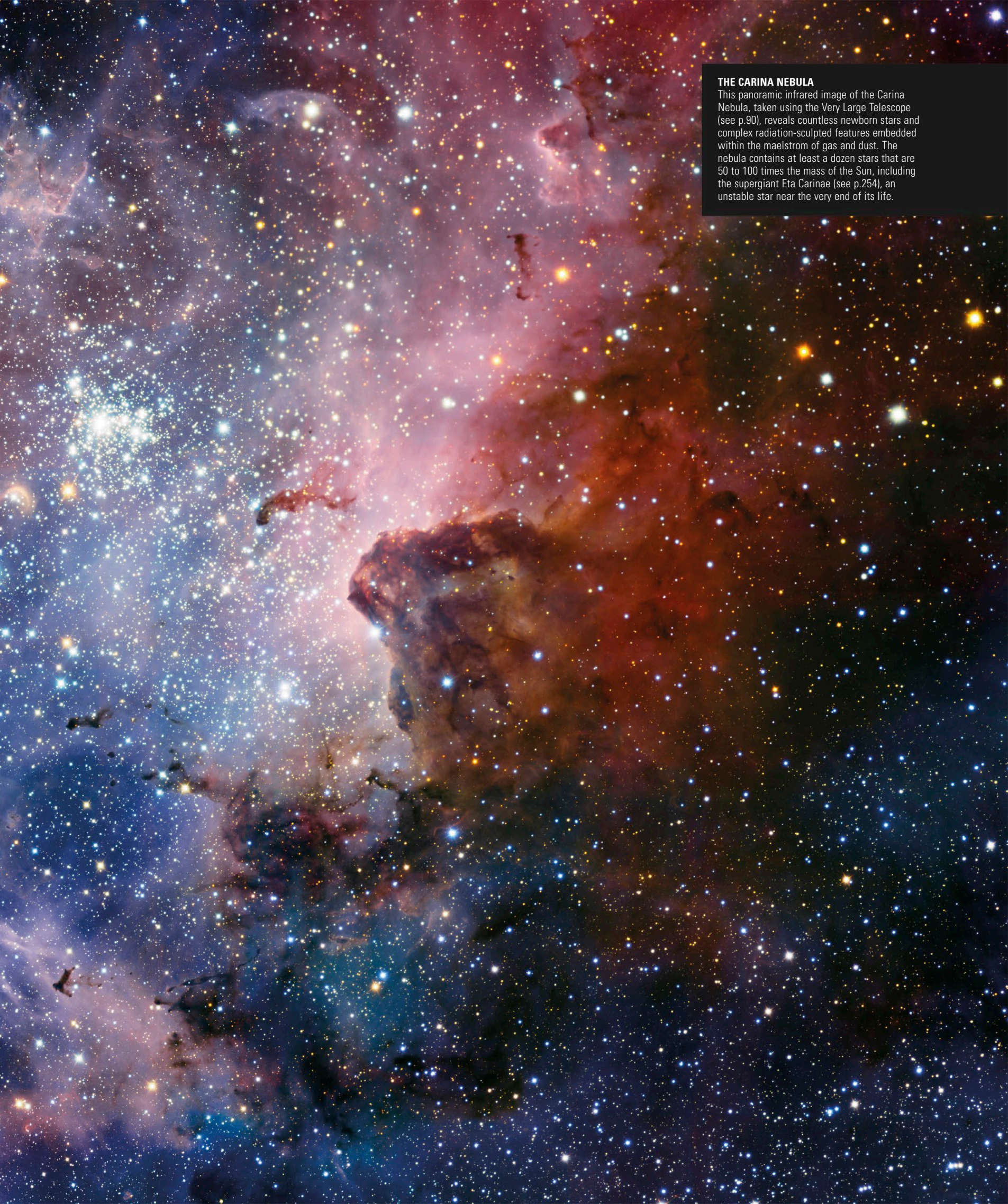




THE CARINA NEBULA

This panoramic infrared image of the Carina Nebula, taken using the Very Large Telescope (see p.90), reveals countless newborn stars and complex radiation-sculpted features embedded within the maelstrom of gas and dust. The nebula contains at least a dozen stars that are 50 to 100 times the mass of the Sun, including the supergiant Eta Carinae (see p.254), an unstable star near the very end of its life.